

Ultra Explorer

Although Windows Explorer manages your files to an adequate level, other tools give you added functionality and a higher level of operability. One such software is UltraExplorer.

• Installation

UltraExplorer is available as a free download and is light on resources.

• Functionality

Ultra Explorer's functionality is similar to the usual Explorer. You have the usual options to navigate one level up, go back or move forward. The bar at the bottom gives you the file count, size and other details.

• Navigation

Double-click anywhere to go one level up. The Folder window on the left is similar to Windows Explorer.

UltraExplorer also has multi-tabbed browsing. To do this, go to **File > New Tab** or use the keyboard shortcut [Ctrl] + [T].

• List/View window

To enable this, go to **View > Windows > List View Window**. This helps you see the changes you are making within the destination window from the source window (eg. a move operation). You can now keep tab on both.

• Favourites window

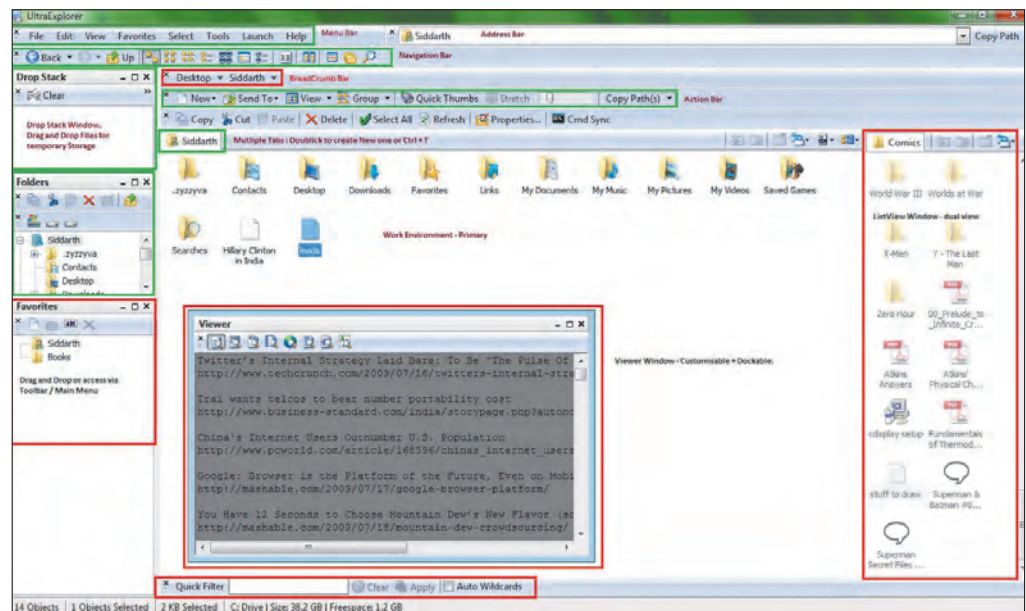
There's also a Favourites window that you need to enable in a way similar to the List/view window. You can drag and drop the most commonly used programs or folders into the side dock.

• Indexing service

Using UltraExplorer's indexing service, you can create real-time filters. The Filter Window (**View > Windows > Filter Window**) allows you to create, filter in and filter out (filter all similar matches out of the list) search options. It's fully customisable with extensions (eg. MP3, TXT) and wildcard options. If you want to search for a file that starts with A and ends with a JPEG, you can run a search for **a*t.*.jpeg**. For one character, use ?, while * is the wildcard for multiple characters, or view only folders.

• Drag and drop search

UltraExplorer seems quite



Some of the features seen need to be enabled.

pleased with the drag and drop option. If you want to sort out only MP3 files, and you're too bored to create new filter or type in *.mp3, simply drag an MP3 file on to your Filter Window and UltraExplorer will do the rest.

• DropStack window

If you're transferring files from multiple locations and the destination is the same, you would have to open all the windows, either laboriously drag and drop each one, or Cut and Paste. The DropStack serves as a temporary location for all your file operations. Drag files on to the drop stack and then you can batch process operations on them. The scope for utility is excellent

(zipping together files in different regions, batch conversions and mass transfers are typical examples).

• Viewer window

The Viewer window lets you preview the file before opening. This is extremely useful for small text, binary, HTML or media files. It opens pictures, text files, PDFs, MP3s and AVI files.

• Quick filter bar

To activate the quick filter bar, go to **View > Toolbars > Quick**

Filter. It's simpler and more utilitarian when compared to the Filters Window. The Drives toolbar gives easy access to all mapped drives. It also allows easy access to USB drives, CD drives and other externals connected to it.

If you're familiar with Windows, you'll know the different view modes - Thumbnails, List, Details, Icons are common.

The number of ways to enable these modes is numerous. The most obvious is **View > Column Mode**. It is similar to the Treelist view, but allows you to view the folders and subfolders horizontally.

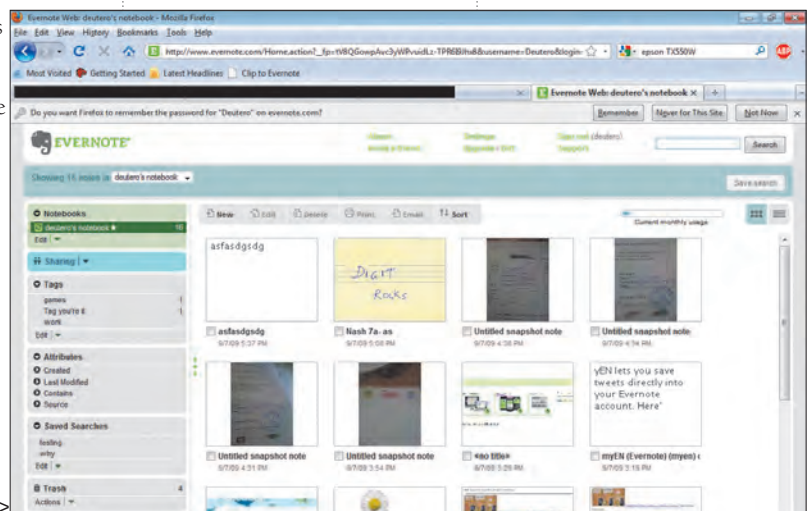
Each window can have a

different colour and font. If you plan to use the software more extensively can use extra plug-ins, get shell extensions, custom theme their environment by giving a different skin to every toolbar (**Tools > Customize**) and several other minute tweaks. You can use the **Windows + [E]** key to access UltraExplorer. To do this, go to **Tools > Shell Extensions > Win+E hook**.

What is interesting to observe is how much utility they've managed to pack in a mere Explorer.

Evernote

Evernote allows you to take notes and synch your notes



Evernote's web interface